

Dell doing well

Dell profits rose 144 per cent; most of the money came from the enterprise sector

512-Core Cluster

A company by the name of SeaMicro recently showed off their 512 Atom processor powered cluster

Q&A

experts, the graphics card I'm using is too slow. I can also feel that when I play games on my Windows 7 64-bit. Is there any way to speed up my graphics card? I like to play *Assassins Creed*, *Prince of Persia*, and *NFS*.

Kesavadev R J

 The GeForce 8400GS is a very basic graphics card. Overclocking graphics



The GeForce 8400GS isn't meant for playing high-end games

cards is possible, but the improvement on a card such as the GeForce 8400GS will yield close to no benefit. Upgrading the graphics card is the only real solution if you play a lot of games.

DVD drive woes

My system configuration is as follows:

Motherboard: ASUS M4N68T-M

Processor: AMD Phenom2 x2 550

RAM: Strontium 2GB (1,333MHz)

OS: Windows XP SP2

UPS: APC back-UPS RS 550

DVD drive: Sony (SATA), ASUS (IDE)

HDD: Seagate 80GB (IDE)

SMPS: Frontech 350W

Monitor: Samsung SyncMaster 591s

I first tried Windows 7 that worked properly, but because of limited HDD space, I changed it to Windows XP.

Now when I try to load Windows 7 with the same disk, it shows missing DVD driver messages with the error code 0x80070017. Also, my DVD drives don't autoplay any more. Some times when I put blank disks in to the Sony drive, it shows errors such as "h : is not accessible."

Allen John

 The error you're facing is because of a corrupted disc or a faulty drive. Make sure that all the connections to the drive are perfect. If possible, try a

different power connector and cable. You can also try the drive on a different PC. If you face the same problem there, it's almost definitely a problem with the drive. You need to purchase a new one.

RAM issues causing start-up problems?

My PC configuration is:

Intel i7 - 950 @ 3.06 GHz

Intel Original DX58SO motherboard

Corsair DDR3 RAM (TR3X6G1600C8D)

6GB Kit. 8-8-8-24 1.65V Version 7.1A

WD Black (WD1002FAEX)

Cooler Master 600 W Power supply.

Dual Boot XP x64 and Windows 7 x64.

I've attached the CPU-Z log file for detail reference. I purchased this PC in October.

The dealer installed 4 GB Corsair XMS3 RAM kit for 6 GB RAM. When I asked for the dominator, he provided me new Corsair DDR3 RAM (TR3X6G1600C8D) 6GB Kit, with some extra money.

Ever since this RAM is installed, it hangs with a POST No display. When I switch the system again after power off, it gives an error that says, "The System BIOS has detected unsuccessful POST attempts Possible causes include recent changes to BIOS performance options or recent hardware changes."

Irrespective of whether I select Y or N, it works fine on the next boot. My PC works fine until I shut it down and start again. I searched for the solution online and came to know that this RAM voltage is higher than recommended. Is it right?

If this is the case, what should I do: change the RAM or tweak the motherboard settings to under value voltage (risky for me). Right now I'm using my PC for a long time. Will it be risky for my motherboard or processor? If I have to change my RAM, which one would be better?

Kiran

 Typically, the motherboard should detect all of its parameters and run flawlessly. Reset all CMOS settings to default and see if the problems continue.

Annoying alerts locking up system

When I start my desktop with XP Professional OS, a warning message appears at the lower corner stating "your computer may be at risk. Automatic upgrades are switched off ...". I'm fine with the message, but till it appears it freezes several programs including Windows Explorer. How can I disable this warning message?

Chandra Mohan Vathyam



Disable all the alerts from the Windows Security Center

 Go to the Windows Security Center in the Control Panel. Click on the Change the way Security Center alerts me link in the left panel. Disable the alerts you don't want to see.

Nonstop BSODs

My PC has been getting numerous BSODs. Making changes to the BIOS configuration and installing Vista haven't helped either. What could the problem be?

Ashish Badoni

 If formatting and reinstalling the OS doesn't help, the problem might lie with some of the hardware. Try running memory diagnostic tests such as Memtest86+ (www.memtest.org). Also install the latest drivers for your motherboard and graphics cards. Install a software called SpeedFan (www.almico.com/speedfan.php). Look out for rising CPU and graphics card temperatures. If those are spiralling out of control, you should look for problems with the fan. 